



Viruses in the army

Apart from grappling with local insurgents, the US army in Iraq is fighting a steadily losing war with computer viruses. Bootleg porn CDs, purchased locally, which are widely popular in the army are infected with viruses and worms. Military commanders are worried that the infected computers could pose a security threat



Friend Connect

Google has unveiled a new service called Friend Connect, which allows any site to add social networking features for free without any programming. These features can be added in the form of widgets developed by Google as well as third-party developers

HEARTLESS HACKERS

A New Low For Hackers



Hackers are always up to things. They steal data like credit card information, break into servers and bring Websites down and make life hell for network admins. Rarely, however do they cause direct physical harm to their victims.

However, hackers reached a new low when they broke into Epilepsy Foundation's Website (www.epilepsyfoundation.org). As its name indicates, this foundation acts as a support group to epileptic patients, who form the bulk of visitors. Many of them are susceptible to seizures on exposure to brightly coloured lights and images. Such patients were affected by the malicious stunt of the hackers who flooded the site's user forums with links to pages full of brightly flashing images. According to media reports, many

people suffered splitting headaches and near seizures.

This attack seems to be more like one of those show-off stunts that are made just to prove a point. However, authorities are taking this attack seriously and the FBI is investigating this incident. Forum users of the foundation are no longer allowed to post animated images. Meanwhile in a world where computers are pervading even the most personal of spaces, such direct attacks can cause significantly more havoc than the botnets of today.

CAMPUS VIDEO

Promotion 2.0

Colleges and universities in the US are becoming smarter in promoting their brand name. No more are they content in only sending out recruiters to high schools or designing glossy promotional material. The latest playground is the Internet—specifically sites like YouTube. These colleges have started YouTube channels to showcase what they have to offer to prospective students.

Students among the segments on YouTube and most of the content they create have some sort of relationship with where they study. There are possibly hundreds of thousands of videos of folks doing backflips, peeing from dorm

windows and chilling out. While these videos don't say anything for the facilities that the particular school offers, there are often some videos like those of hazing rituals, leaky classrooms and racist fights that might harm the reputation of universities. Keeping this fact in mind, the colleges have started uploading positive videos to drown out the negative ones.

Colleges are also holding video competitions among students where the best gets to be the official promotional video for that institution. This approach is more effective because prospective students would more likely watch videos made by people from the same age group and the colleges also save on expenses incurred by hiring an ad agency.

Apart from YouTube, academic institutions have been hawking their wares in places like iTunesU and Facebook. These videos have won both brickbats and bouquets from the student community. On a side note, using such videos for promoting educational institutions is already catching on in India, especially among private institutions. A few years ago, Manipal University came out with its own promotional video based on the *Summer of 69* track, which has had thousands of views on YouTube as well as being watched in college LANs across India.

SUPERPOD

Chips And Supercomputers

Did you ever expect your humble iPod to be used for services to science? If everything goes according to plan a supercomputer five years down the